



Conference on Learning and
Student Success
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Deshaming AI in Education

Practicing Courageous Care in Faculty AI Development

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Disclosure

We have no conflicts of interest to disclose.

Any mention of a specific company or brand name is merely for example, not to be seen as an endorsement.

Context

The five “W’s” Matter



Boise State University

- Early AI initiatives and AI Coordinating Council governance structure were underway.
- The AI charter was developed and in a draft state.
- Center for Teaching & Learning and eCampus provided initial AI training opportunities.
- The AI Liaison initiative launched to gather departmental input.
- Sustained faculty development was uneven across the university.
- [Boisestate.ai](https://boisestate.ai) beta launched.

Context (May 2025)

The Two Faces of Shame

Internal Shame (The Skill Gap)

"I am not an expert"

"I am falling behind"

"I don't understand the
'black box'."

External Shame (The Social Risk)

"My colleagues will think I'm lazy"

"I'm betraying my craft"

"I'll be seen as anti-intellectual."

Courageous Care: Addressing both the person and the culture.

Context

UNESCO AI Competency Framework for Teachers

Aspects	Progression		
	Acquire	Deepen	Create
1. Human-centred mindset	Human agency	Human accountability	Social responsibility
2. Ethics of AI	Ethical principles	Safe and responsible use	Co-creating ethical rules
3. AI foundations and applications	Basic AI techniques and applications	Application skills	Creating with AI
4. AI pedagogy	AI-assisted teaching	AI–pedagogy integration	AI-enhanced pedagogical transformation
5. AI for professional development	AI enabling lifelong professional learning	AI to enhance organizational learning	AI to support professional transformation

Context

Digital Education Council AI Literacy Framework

		Competency Level		
		Level 1	Level 2	Level 3
Literacy Dimensions	 Dimension 1 Understanding AI and Data	AI and Data Awareness	AI and Data in Action	AI and Data Optimisation
	 Dimension 2 Critical Thinking and Judgement	Question AI Output	Evaluate AI Output	Challenge AI Output
	 Dimension 3 Ethical and Responsible Use	Understand Risks	Apply Responsible Practices	Shape Responsible Practices
	 Dimension 4 Human-Centricity, Emotional Intelligence, and Creativity	Awareness of Human-AI Interaction	AI as Collaborative Tool	Develop Human-Centred AI Practices
	 Dimension 5 Domain Expertise	Applied AI Awareness	AI Application in Professional Contexts	Strategic AI Leadership

Context

Case Study

What

Case Study



Boise State AI Institute

- **The Model:** 3-Day Hybrid (May 19-21, 2025)
- **The Space:** Held in "The Incubator" to foster a "safe-to-fail" community
- **The Incentive:** Stipends and recognized time
- **The Intention:** "Explore" and "Critique", rather than "Master"
- **Being Human:** Recognizing faculty as parents, caretakers, and whole humans

Case Study

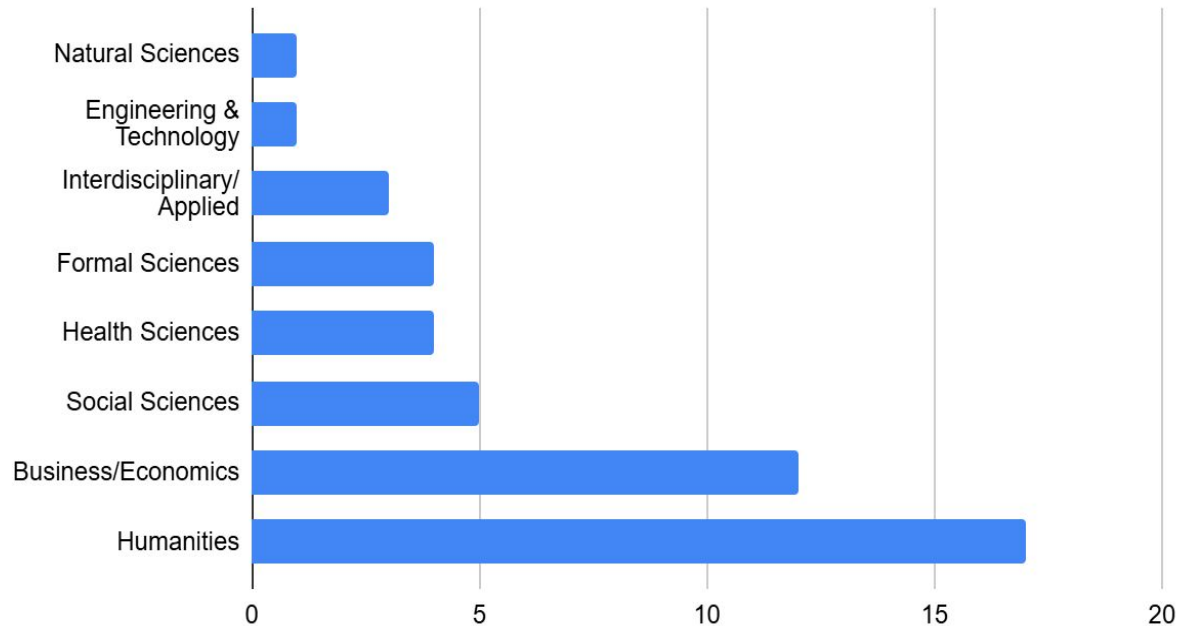
Who

Case Study

The “Who”

Participant Count by Discipline

(Count of participants who completed both pre/post surveys)

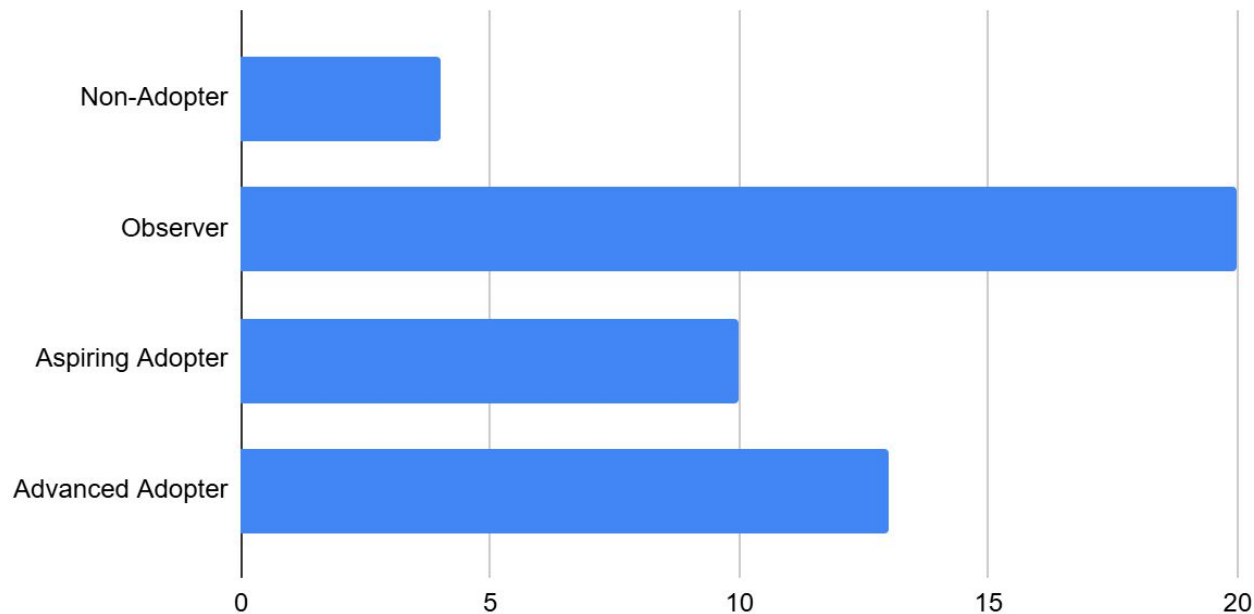


Case Study

The Baseline

Participant Count by Level of AI Adoption

(Count of participants who completed both pre/post surveys)



Case Study

Impact

Case Study

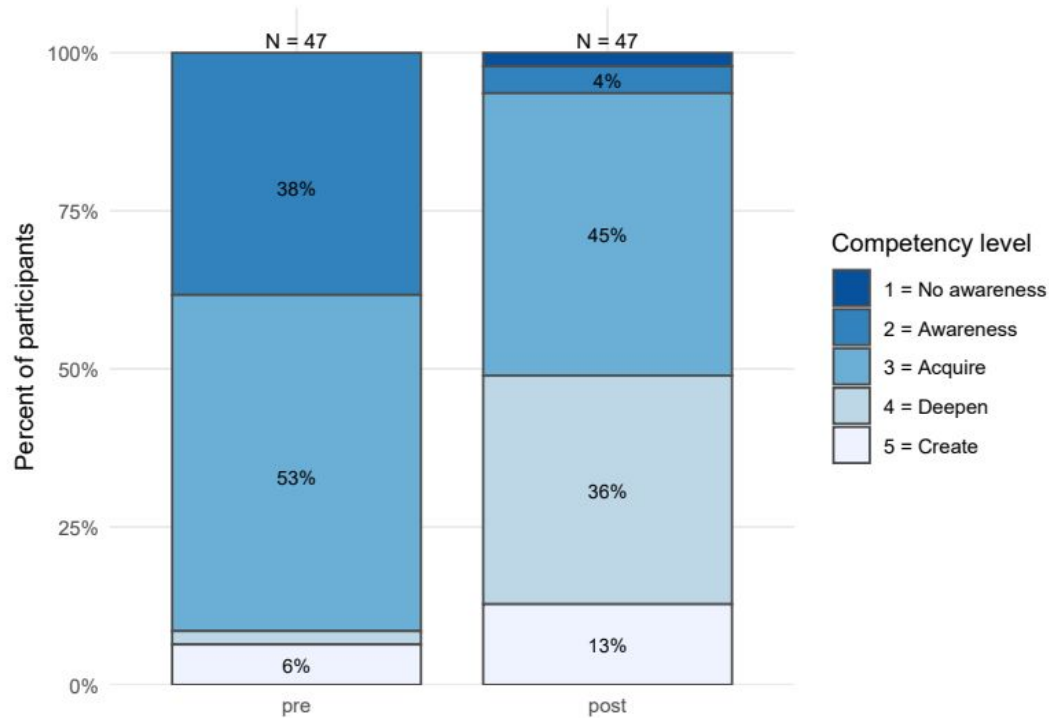


Figure 3.1: Global AI competency levels: Pre vs. Post shows stacked percent bars with within-bar percent labels and total N.

The “Observer” Effect

"I thought I was either going to feel like a complete idiot or like I didn't belong here... but I felt like the people who knew so much just wanted to help."

The “Observer” group was most likely to report positive changes of at least one step in competency.

Tactical De-shaming

- Messaging in advertising
 - designed for educators who wish to **explore critical, ethical, and practical applications** of AI
- Daily intentionality of ensuring safety to engage, or simply be there in curiosity.
- Engagement vs. Adoption
- Peer teachers and leaders
- Space to reflect and challenge

Centering your intention & expectations

AI Institute Daily Reflection Journal

DAY 1: MONDAY, MAY 19

MORNING INTENTION

What do you hope to explore or discover today?

How do you want to show up—as a learner, collaborator or contributor?

Case Study



Peer Catalyst Strategy

- Engage the “Advanced Adopters” as peer leaders
- Strategic placement of “energizers”
- Building trust through vulnerability
- Sharing success and failure

Case Study

Activity: Reflecting on Frameworks

What's my Context?

Think/Pair/Share

1. In your context, is the primary barrier Internal Shame (Skill) or External Shame (Culture/Norms)?
2. Where does your campus house AI literacy development (Central vs. Local)?



Link to slide deck for reference

Activity Part 1

UNESCO & Digital Education Council Frameworks

Think of faculty development examples in your context. Do these frameworks make you rethink the curriculum/approach?

- Which parts of each framework apply to your context?
- Are you starting locally or universally?
- What disciplinary expertise and/or unique qualities must be included?
- How are you intentionally designing to de-shame and engage in honest curiosity across interdisciplinary opportunities?
- How are you recognizing the humanity of your participants?
- How will you evolve your strategy?

Next Step Examples



Influencing Local Strategy- School of Nursing

- Leadership support
- N224 Nursing Informatics & Technology
 - AI literacy training module for all undergrads
- AI Task Force Committee
 - Formal committee (service)
- AAC&U AI Insitute
 - Developed scaffolded [faculty curriculum](#)
- AI Scale [language/icons](#) for assignment instructions
 - Standardizing across SON
- Cross campus collaboration

Informed Engagement

2026 Boise State AI Institute for Teaching & Learning

Open to all faculty (including adjuncts) regardless of AI background, who plan to teach a course in Fall 2026 or Spring 2027. Past attendees may reapply; this institute's content is new and updated.

Institute Learning Outcomes:

ILO 1: Select and experiment with discipline-specific AI tools.

ILO 2: Identify evaluation criteria (accuracy, consistency, reliability) to assess appropriate AI use, content, bias, or inconsistencies.

ILO 3: Explore balanced ethical strategies to mitigate risks related to bias, data privacy, and academic integrity when using AI.

ILO 4: Identify scenarios where AI lacks human sensitivity and develop responses (in course design, assessment, etc.) to AI's influence on human behavior and classroom interaction.

ILO 5: Design discipline-specific practices (assignments, assessments, feedback, activities).

- 85+ faculty enrolled, representing all colleges.
- Hybrid format: 10-15 faculty joining online.
- **By the numbers:** Two plenaries, three mini plenaries, two external speakers, two panels (ethics and AI in the Arts), twelve planning team-designed sessions/workshops.
- Research on institute efficacy (iterating from last year's findings).

Evolving the AI Institute

Be Curious

Be Courageous

Be Tenacious

Thank you!

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[AI at Boise State website](#)

References

UNESCO. (2024). AI competency framework for teachers. United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization. <https://doi.org/10.54675/ZJTE2084>

Digital Education Council. (2024, June 13). *Digital Education Council AI literacy framework*. <https://www.digitaleducationcouncil.com/post/digital-education-council-ai-literacy-framework>